



Unsafe Building May 14, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gyqgOILryh4
Publication Date	2026-05-15T08:35:26Z
Target Category	muncie_city

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Unsafe Building Hearing Authority Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: May 14, 2026

Body: Unsafe Building Hearing Authority

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer opened the May 14, 2026 meeting of the Unsafe Building Hearing Authority at **00:00:11**. The unsafe building law (IC 36-7-9) was formally entered into the record.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Gretchen Cheeseman (Mayor), Dan Rydenower (Councilman), Jeff Green, and James Heimlet (Historical Preservation).
 - **City Staff Present:** Taylor Reid, Richard Rawlings, and Danny Han (Administrators); Courtney Walker (Recording Secretary).
 - **City Attorneys:** Unavailable/Absent.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Administration of the collective oath to participants testifying at the hearing (**00:02:32**).

- **Approval of Minutes:** *Not explicitly detailed in the transcript.*
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

New Cases <U+2014> Rehab Orders

- **00:03:00 Case No. 5: 333 East North Street (Unit 7)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** City staff / Tenant testimony (Tracy Dotr).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Tenant testified regarding severe structural neglect, unsafe floors, rodent/rat droppings, lack of a refrigerator, and alleged landlord harassment. The property owner/manager (Southwest Units LLC) failed to appear. Staff noted that no other tenants had officially called for inspections, though conditions are severe.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to affirm the rehab order and issue a \$5,000 civil penalty for non-compliance and failure to appear, with a 30-day continuance. Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:08:41 Case No. 6: 614<U+00BD> West Powers Street**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Arlina Staten (Owner's niece representing owners Laura and William Smith).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Property tagged in April for roof, gutters, fascia, soffit, windows, exposed wood, foundation tuck-pointing, and fence repairs. Representative explained the elderly owners lack income, and she is pursuing community development assistance programs and establishing credit to secure a home improvement loan.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to affirm the rehab order and continue for 30 days to the June 11th hearing. Approved by Voice Vote (**00:13:41**).
- **00:14:00 Case No. 7: 706 West Powers Street**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Adam Cratesman (Owner/Resident).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Tagged for roof, guttering, fascia board, and soffit repairs. Owner stated intent to complete repairs toward the end of summer. Staff noted the owner may income-qualify for a community development roof program.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to affirm the rehab order and continue for 90 days to August 13th. Approved by Voice Vote (**00:16:16**).
- **00:16:38 Case No. 12: 808 West Powers Street**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Walter Bo (Representative for owner Rick Russell).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Tagged for roof, guttering, and fascia. Representative reported that the roof has been finished and gutter hangers installed, though high winds caused repeated shingle damage.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to affirm the rehab order and continue for 30 days, with instructions that calling for a passed inspection prior will release the

property without returning. Approved by Voice Vote (00:19:19).

- **00:19:42 Case No. 14: 815 West Powers Street**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Walter Bo (Representative for owner).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Tagged for window framing, roof repairs, guttering, fascia, soffit, and debris. Representative noted roof work is done and fascia/gutters are next, requesting a 30- to 60-day window.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to affirm the rehab order and continue to the July 9th hearing, with provisions for early inspection release. Approved by Voice Vote (00:21:08).
- **00:21:31 Case No. 16: 918 West Powers Street**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Owner/Resident.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Tagged for roof, guttering, and trash. Owner reported clearing out branches, replacing and painting fascia boards, masonry tuck-pointing, and removing the flue. Staff recommended checking community development programs for roof assistance after resolving other code items.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to affirm the rehab order, require a progress inspection, and continue for 30 days. Approved by Voice Vote (00:24:00).
- **00:24:17 Case No. 17: 925 West Powers Street**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** April Lear (Owner).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Tagged regarding garage condition (missing garage door, board windows, exposed wood, missing gutters, garage roof). Owner stated the property is listed for sale through Remax until the end of August for \$69,500. If unsold, repairs will be initiated.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to affirm the rehab order and continue to August 13th. Approved by Voice Vote (00:29:28).

New Cases <U+2014> Demolition Orders

- **00:30:09 Case No. 25: 712 West Queen Street**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Andrew Heimer (Representative).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Originally a demolition order for a garage. Representative noted a building permit was paid for and pulled today to rebuild the roof structure, fix fascia/soffit, install gutters, and straighten bowed walls.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to modify the demolition order to a rehab order and continue for 30 days. Approved by Voice Vote (00:31:45).

Continued Cases <U+2014> Rehab Orders

- **00:32:13 Case No. 28: 117 East 7th Street**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chad Hart (Representing owner Robin/estate).

- **Deliberation Summary:** Representative stated sale fell through; they intend to retain and rehab the property for rental. Roof repairs were made, but no building permit has been obtained yet. Exterior debris has been cleaned up.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to continue for 30 days, requiring a building permit, an inspection at least a week prior, and an explicit rehab plan. Approved by Voice Vote (00:35:13).
- **00:35:38 Case No. 29: 626 West 9th Street**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nicholas Hutchinson (Owner/Resident).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Owner explained delays due to a pending legal case and the temporary denial of a community development roof application while legal proceedings are active. Court date is set for June 22nd. Yard maintenance has been hindered by personal circumstances.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to continue to the July 9th hearing for an update following the June 22nd court proceeding. Approved by Voice Vote (00:38:44).
- **00:39:02 Case No. 33: 1 East 29th Street**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Heather McKibben (Owner/Business representative).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Property inspected regarding a large volume of vehicles stored on-site (approximately 185-195 cars). Owner reported removing 8 vehicles this month, utilizing a new business consultation service ("fix the owner, fix the business"), hiring a new mechanic starting Monday, contracting with Cardinal Mowing, and working on older vehicle inventory reduction. City staff and board expressed concern over slow vehicle reduction compared to prior commitments of 40 cars/month, and noted zoning/salvage constraints.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to assess a civil penalty of \$5,000 (eligible for forgiveness upon compliance), continue for 30 days, require 25 cars to be removed from the lot by the next hearing, and require a detailed written inventory and cleanup plan classifying pre-2010 vehicles. Approved by Voice Vote (00:10:31 / recorded via 3 yes votes).
- **00:11:23 Case No. 34: 1613 East Andover Drive**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Walter Bo (Representative).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Representative reported that final items should be completed within a month due to prior owner delays.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to continue for 30 days. Approved by Voice Vote (00:12:26).
- **00:12:43 Case No. 35: 501 North Bennett Street**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Melissa Hendris (Resident/Prospective Owner).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Inspection on the 11th showed progress on the roof and exterior. Resident is waiting to formalize title transfer from her deceased father's estate via her sister's sign-off before submitting a free roof application. Front siding repairs are planned.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to continue for 30 days. Approved by Voice Vote (00:15:36).
- **00:16:03 Case No. 43: 1617 South Madison Street**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Julio Munoz (Representing new property owner).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Property has been sold and transferred. Building and electrical permits pulled; power relocated; chimney siding wrapped and repaired. The burnt shed was removed. Only minor siding on the chimney and rear remains.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to transfer the case from demo/rehab tracking to administrative enforcement. Approved by Voice Vote (00:19:46).
- **00:20:06 Case No. 45: 801 West North Street**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Joseph Fleming (Representing Cheryl Buys LLC).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Representative discussed electrical upgrade estimates required by code, elimination of illegal basement and attic apartment units to reduce density from 9 to fewer units, and front porch structural repairs.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to continue for 90 days. Approved by Voice Vote (00:25:08).
- **00:25:24 Case No. 46: 313 West Oakland Avenue**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Maximov (Owner).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Owner reported roof replaced, lawn maintained, and gas utility/meter replaced. Three new windows have been ordered. Owner lost employment, slowing progress. Currently using the property as a mailing address and intends to complete bathroom installations.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to move the property to administrative enforcement. Approved by Voice Vote (00:12:18 / 01:28:19).

Continued Cases <U+2014> Demolition Orders

- **01:28:50 Case No. 48: 2604 East 16th Street**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Robin Flowers (Owner).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Submitted a comprehensive written rehab plan with cost estimates. Trailers and vehicles removed. Owners plan to work from front to back in phases, handling porch and exterior repairs.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to continue for 90 days, requiring a pre-hearing inspection to assess permit requirements for future rehab modification. Approved by Voice Vote (01:34:05).
- **01:35:53 Case No. 51: 1421 East Highland Avenue**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Long (Owner).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Owner reported siding, gutters, fascia, and soffit completed; shed painted and secured; lawn mowed. Stated intent to fully rehab or sell within 60 days. Staff noted the original tag date expired, placing it functionally under administrative enforcement status.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** No formal board action taken due to order expiration; owner instructed to continue work toward release.
 - **01:37:54 Case No. 54: 1127 South Jefferson Street**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jennifer Collus (Representing Wilson Acquisitions / Middletown).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Building permit obtained; awaiting remaining contractor bids for the remodel.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to continue for 90 days, with potential early release upon passed inspection. Approved by Voice Vote (**01:40:52**).
 - **01:41:01 Case No. 55: 2204 South Vine Street**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jennifer Collus (Representing Wilson Acquisitions).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Tenants have vacated, granting interior and garage access. Pest control treated roaches and mice three times. Awaiting contractor bids to repair roof leaks and garage structure.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to continue for 90 days. Approved by Voice Vote (**01:42:55** - *Note: Voice vote response captured alongside background chatter*).
 - **01:43:22 Case No. 56: 2003 South Jefferson Street**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Elquestto Brown (Owner).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Owner discovered foundation failure caused by a tree trunk and rotten masonry during attempted repairs. Financial setbacks from business accounts stalled progress. Materials are on-site, and his son (a union brickmason) will execute repairs once recovered from a back injury. Building permit needs renewal.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to continue for 60 days, requiring a renewed permit and an inspection prior to the next hearing. Approved by Voice Vote (**01:47:09**).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *No separate general open public comment period or citizen forum was conducted outside of specific case testimonies.*
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Staff discussed administrative tracking of county-deeded properties, such as a property on South Jefferson/Mifflin.
 - Presiding officer noted the docket disposition for properties where no owners appeared.

- **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned following the adoption of bulk default orders for non-appearing docket properties ([01:51:48](#)).

Muncie Policy Memo Civic Monitoring Automated Pipeline. Report generated on 2026-09-15 02:00:53 using model gemini-3.5-flash-lite.